

Worcester Polytechnic Institute
Student Branch of the
Institute of Electrical and Electronics Engineers
Branch Bylaws

Approved September 30th 2026



Preamble

The Worcester Polytechnic Institute (WPI) Institute of Electrical and Electronics Engineers (IEEE) Student Branch, like its parent organization, was founded with the purpose of “advancing technology for the betterment of humanity”. To this end, the WPI IEEE Student Branch serves to enrich the collegiate experience of WPI’s students, faculty, and staff who have an interest in electronics and technology.

This document shall outline the Bylaws of the WPI IEEE Student Branch.

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Bylaw A - Basic Laws

A.1 Name

The name of this organization shall be the Institute of Electrical and Electronics Engineers (IEEE) Worcester Polytechnic Institute (WPI) Student Branch, hereafter referred to as the Branch.

A.2 External Policy

The Branch shall abide by all policies put forth by IEEE and WPI, including, but not limited to, anti-discrimination policies and anti-hazing policies. Furthermore, the Branch shall abide by all federal, state, and local laws.

A.3 Parliamentary Procedure

All Branch proceedings will follow Robert's Rules of Order for guidance on parliamentary rulings and procedures.

A.4 Faculty Advisor

The Branch shall be advised by a WPI faculty member, hereafter referred to as the faculty advisor. The responsibilities and appointment of the faculty advisor shall be based upon IEEE's recommendation, which follows. The faculty advisor shall be appointed by the IEEE Regional Director upon the recommendation of the executive board and the WPI Electrical and Computer Engineering Department.

Bylaw B - Updating the Bylaws

B.1 Schedule

To keep the Bylaws up to date and in line with the Branch's needs, the Bylaws are to be reviewed and updated, if found necessary, once every two years following the process described in B.2

B.2 Bylaws Update Procedure

To update the Bylaws, the Chair and Vice Chair must meet to discuss and draft possible changes. When all the desired updates have been drafted, the Chair and Vice Chair will present these changes to the executive board at an executive board meeting. Each change, individually, will then be discussed and voted on as a formal motion (See F.2).

Bylaw C - Membership

C.1 Classes of Membership

The Branch shall have three classes of membership:

- **General Member:** A WPI student who has attended at least one Branch event, but does not satisfy the requirements of being an active member.
- **Active Member:** A WPI student who satisfies the requirements of active member status, as defined in C.2.
- **Executive:** A WPI undergraduate student who is a member of the executive board.

C.2 Requirements of Active Member Status

Active member status shall be granted to WPI students who have at least 3 membership points. This threshold assumes that Branch events are held approximately every week throughout the term, for all four terms in the academic year. Adjust this threshold if this event frequency is not met. Point assignment values are specified in E.2.

Membership points are accumulated across a rolling semester. A rolling semester is defined as a contiguous span of two terms where a student is not on leave. If a student is on leave, they must notify the executive board to exclude the term they are away from the rolling period. The executive board will evaluate exceptions under extenuating circumstances on a case-by-case basis.

Bylaw D - Executive Board

D.1 Components

The executive board shall serve as the central authority of the Branch. The executive board shall be composed of the following positions, hereafter referred to as executives:

1. Chair
2. Vice Chair
3. Treasurer
4. Secretary
5. Events Chairs
6. Projects Chair
7. Public Relations Chair
8. Web Chair

Executives shall be elected as outlined in Bylaw G. When "highest-ranking executive" is referenced, use the order of the list above as the ranking.

D.2 Expectations of Executives

Executives shall be expected to:

- Maintain the status of an active member.
- Be in attendance, excused, or on leave for all Branch activities, including executive board meetings.
- Satisfy all requirements specific to the executive's position.
- Share the responsibilities of the executive board.
- Maintain familiarity with the Branch bylaws.
- Maintain IEEE Student Membership throughout the duration of their term as an executive.

D.3 25 Live Access Priority

25 Live is WPI's platform for booking campus spaces. Because the number of authorized users fluctuates and is determined by the Student Activities Office (SAO), the following list establishes the priority order for receiving access:

1. Chair
2. Events Chairs
3. Projects Chair
4. Vice Chair

5. Secretary
6. Treasurer
7. Public Relations Chair
8. Web Chair

D.4 Chair

The Chair may also be referred to as the President in accordance with WPI Executive Board regulations. It shall be the responsibility of the Chair to oversee the operations of the Branch in its entirety. This duty shall entail:

- Meeting with executives to discuss and develop goals and achievements.
- Moderating executive board meetings.
- Assigning tasks to executives that fall outside their designated responsibilities.
- Preparing an annual Branch plan during A-Term and submitting it in vTools.
- Submitting at least four event reports in vTools over the academic year.
- Maintaining executive reporting in vTools.
- Serving as a representative on the Department of Electrical and Computer Engineering (ECE) Student Advisory Board under the ECE Department Head.
- Maintaining the Branch Bylaws.

D.5 Vice Chair

The Vice Chair may also be referred to as the Vice President in accordance with WPI Executive Board regulations. It shall be the responsibility of the Vice Chair to oversee the internal operations of the Branch. This duty shall entail:

- Assisting the Chair with their duties.
- Helping fellow executives discuss and develop goals and achievements.
- Holding fellow executives accountable for failing to meet responsibilities.
- Providing fellow executives with resources and assistance as needed.
- Upholding the Bylaws.
- Ensuring strong coordination and cooperation amongst all executives.

D.6 Treasurer

It shall be the responsibility of the treasurer to oversee the Branch finances. Although they are the sole member with access to funds, they are not the sole moderator of the funds' usage, but rather a guide for how the funds are to be used. This duty shall entail:

- Serving as the financial advisor for the Branch.
- Submitting an annual budget proposal to the WPI Student Government Association (SGA).
- Submitting Funding Requests to the SGA a minimum of 2 weeks before the intended use date.
- Pursuing funds from external sources including, but not limited to, the IEEE Worcester County Section (WCS), the WPI ECE department, and corporate sponsors.
- Maintaining Branch funds:
 - Within the Branch's budget.
 - Received from SGA via funding requests.
 - Received from outside sponsors.
 - Within the Branch's gift fund held by the ECE department.
- Maintaining a history of Branch finances.
- Completing reimbursements for pre-approved purchases.

D.7 Secretary

It shall be the responsibility of the secretary to oversee the administration of the Branch. This duty shall entail:

- Recording meeting minutes during executive board meetings and sending out action items afterward.
- Maintaining member attendance records at Branch activities.
- Updating member activity status as required.
- Maintaining the Branch file system, which includes the Google Drive folder.
- Creating and sending out the Branch weekly newsletter.
- Ensuring synchronization between myWPI members and the email alias.

D.8 Events Chairs

There shall be two Events Chairs, and it will be the responsibility of the Events Chairs to coordinate all logistics and planning for Branch activities, including coordinating with other executives when needed. This duty shall entail:

- Arranging weekly events, which must include the following each term of the academic year:
 - One General Body Meeting (GBM)
 - One technical event
 - One social event
 - One flagship event
- Uploading event details into MyWPI 1.5-2 weeks before said event takes place.
- Filling out the event template 1.5-2 weeks before said event takes place.
- Being the main point of contact for other student groups on campus for collaboration.
- Maintaining the events calendar.

D.9 Projects Chair

It will be the responsibility of the Projects Chair to create and maintain technical projects that promote and/or benefit the Branch and WPI community. This duty shall entail:

- Identifying at least one project that can be completed or improved upon every academic year.
- Maintaining existing projects to ensure that they are operational.
- Open-sourcing and maintaining all projects on the Branch's GitHub organization.
- Managing the Projects budget.

D.10 Public Relations Chair

It will be the responsibility of the Public Relations Chair to promote and document Branch events. This duty shall entail:

- Designing graphics for events.
- Promoting events and meetings in ways including, but not limited to, posting to social media, hanging posters and fliers, and advertising on campus televisions.
- Documenting events by taking photos and/or videos and posting recaps.
- Coming up with ideas for WPI IEEE Branded Merchandise.

D.11 Web Chair

It will be the responsibility of the Web Chair to maintain, update, and improve the Branch website. This duty shall entail:

- Ensuring the website is publicly accessible at all times.
- Ensuring the website's code base is organized and version controlled.
- Making sure events, executives, projects, and other content on the website is up to date.
- Maintaining the website calendar.
- Improving the website by adding or improving features each academic term.

Bylaw E - Meetings

E.1 Classes of Meetings

The Branch shall have four classes of meetings:

- **General Body Meeting:** A meeting held at least once per term, ideally at the beginning of the term, that is open to all WPI students. During general body meetings, the branch will discuss updates and future events. Elections may also be run during or in place of the C-Term General Body Meeting.
- **Events:** Organized activities, gatherings, or initiatives held to foster engagement, promote the club's mission, and provide opportunities for member involvement. Events may include workshops, social gatherings, professional development opportunities, and other activities aligned with the club's objectives.
- **Flagship Event:** Flagship events are large-scale events that happen once per academic term. The current set of flagship events is described below. Each flagship event requires the formation of a committee to assist in the planning and execution of these large events (See Bylaw I for a description of committees).
 - **A-Term: PCB Design Class** – A project-oriented hardware design course where students learn PCB design over several weeks, then design, receive, and assemble their own PCBs. (Location: Flexible, Date: Early September)
 - **B-Term: Spark Party** – A night to celebrate the ECE department's accomplishments, featuring music and dance performances from student groups, WCS demonstrations, faculty and MQP presentations, with a finale tesla coil performance. (Location: AK 116, Date: Early December)
 - **C-Term: Networking Night** – A unique opportunity for highly motivated, talented, technical WPI students across different majors to connect with top companies in the industry over a catered dinner. (Location: CC Odeum, Date: Late January)
- **Executive Board Meeting:** A 1-hour meeting held once per week during all academic terms that is open to the WPI community. During executive board meetings, the executive board discusses and plans Branch activities and votes on Branch matters.

E.2 Meeting Attendance

There shall be four classes of meeting attendance for all Branch meetings:

- **In Attendance:** The person was present for the majority of the meeting.
- **Excused:** The person was not present for the majority of the meeting, and they sent a valid excuse to the executive board prior to the start of the meeting.
- **Absent:** The person was not present for the majority of the meeting, and they did not send a valid excuse to the executive board prior to the start of the meeting.

- **On Leave:** The person was away from campus for the academic term in which the meeting was held for reasons including but not limited to Interactive Qualifying Project (IQP), Major Qualifying Project (MQP), or Co-op.

Branch activities will be assigned the following point values:

- Events: 1.0 point
- General Body Meetings: 1.0 point
- Executive Board Meetings: 0.50 points
- PCB Design Lecture: 0.5

Bylaw F - Voting Procedure

F.1 Voting Membership

The voting membership is the set of people who are eligible to vote in a certain ballot. For executive elections, the voting membership is the set of active members. For formal motions at executive board meetings, the voting membership is the set of executives.

F.2 Formal Motions

During an executive board meeting, any executive may make a formal motion. The motion shall be discussed and, if necessary, voted on as outlined in Bylaw F.3. Motions include, but are not limited to, the following:

- Amending the Branch Bylaws.
- Approving purchases with Branch funds.
- Impeaching an executive.

F.3 Passing a Motion

When balloting for a motion, each member of the voting membership is entitled to a single vote either in favor of or against the motion. The motion will pass provided that two-thirds of the voting membership votes in favor of the motion. At the discretion of the executive board, the votes may be cast either publicly or anonymously. If the votes are cast publicly, the moderator shall not be entitled to a vote.

F.4 Electing an Executive

Balloting to elect an executive shall occur during a general body meeting and shall proceed as follows:

1. If there are no candidates for the position, the position shall be left vacant until an appointment can be made or the duties of the unfilled position have been equitably distributed among the other executives.
2. If there are two candidates for the position, each member of the voting membership shall be entitled to an anonymous vote for one candidate. The candidate with the largest number of votes shall be elected to the executive position. In the case of a tie, current executive members shall hold a ballot to determine the winner. Executive members cannot participate in this ballot if they are one of the tied candidates. If no consensus is reached during this ballot, the current Chair will determine the new executive member.

3. In the event that more than two candidates are nominated for a single position, the election shall be conducted using an anonymous, ranked-choice ballot. Every member of the voting membership shall be given the right to cast a single ballot, on which they must rank up to three candidates in order of their preference (i.e., first choice, second choice, and third choice).

Bylaw G - Elections

G.1 Schedule

The election of the executive board, hereafter referred to as the election, shall be held at least once a year and shall take place no later than the second-to-last full week of C-term.

G.2 Nominations

The executive board shall notify all active members of the election two weeks prior to the election. Any active member may nominate any undergraduate active member. Active members may be nominated for more than one position. Nominations may be submitted to the executive board up until the start of the election. Upon receiving a nomination, the executive board will immediately notify the nominee. To be a candidate in the election, the nominee must accept the nomination prior to the start of the election. The nomination is assumed to be automatically accepted in the case of a self-nomination.

G.3 Moderators

Elections for each board position shall be moderated by the two highest-ranking executives who do not intend to run for any elected position. To maintain impartiality, moderators may not participate in any discussions or deliberations regarding the election of an executive. In the event that no such members are available, the current Executive Board shall oversee the election of the Chair. Once a Chair has been elected by the general body, the newly elected Chair shall assume responsibility for moderating the election for the Vice Chair, who will then join the newly elected Chair in moderating the elections for the remaining board positions.

G.4 Procedure

When electing an executive the following procedure will be followed:

1. The names of all candidates for the position shall be read.
2. All candidates shall be asked to leave the room.
3. Candidates shall be selected one by one, in a random order. Each selected candidate shall return to the room and may deliver a speech no longer than three minutes. The general body may then ask the selected candidate questions for up to five minutes, following which the selected candidate shall be asked to leave the room.
4. Following this, the general body may discuss the candidates for up to 10 minutes.
5. All candidates shall return to the room, and balloting to elect an executive shall occur as described in Bylaw F.4.

G.5 Transition

Following elections, the current executive board will mentor the incoming officers throughout C-Term. The newly elected board will officially assume their roles at the start of D-Term. This transition period shall include, at minimum, the following:

Current executives shall review and update the transition documents for their respective positions.

Newly elected executives shall:

1. Review the transition materials for their designated roles.
2. Meet with the outgoing executive holding their position.
3. Attend all remaining C-Term executive board meetings.
4. Attend all general body meetings.

Bylaw H - Vacant Executive Position

H.1 Vacancy

Executive positions may become vacant outside of the standard election schedule. This can happen if the executive resigns, is impeached, no executive is elected to the position, the executive graduates early, or the executive is away from campus.

H.2 Delegation of Responsibilities

While a board position remains vacant, the Executive Board shall determine an appropriate method for distributing the associated responsibilities among current executives until the position is formally filled.

H.3 Appointment of an Interim Executive

During any period in which a board position is vacant, the Executive Board shall make reasonable efforts to appoint an interim executive. This process shall include distributing an application to all active members and selecting a suitable candidate for appointment.

H.4 Interim Positions

In the event that an interim is appointed to fill a vacant board position, the interim shall assume all responsibilities and duties associated with that position, as outlined in Bylaw D. These responsibilities shall be upheld until the original executive returns from leave or until the next general board elections are conducted.

Bylaw I - Committees

A committee is a collection of executives and active members who work together to coordinate events or reach club goals.

I.1 Creating a Committee

Committees are required for each of the flagship events (See E.1), as these events require a lot of work. Other committees may be formed for other tasks (e.g., coordinating going to an IEEE conference) by presenting the need at a board meeting and passing a formal motion (See E.2).

I.2 Committee Duties

Committees are expected to meet at least once every other week leading up to the committee's respective event or deadline for the committee's goal. Committees must also record the happenings of their meetings in a minutes format to be submitted to the executive board so they stay updated.

I.3 Committee Structure

All committees must have at least one executive who shall serve as the "Committee Lead". It is the duty of the Committee Lead to make sure the meeting notes are taken and to report back to the executive board. In the event there is more than one executive on a committee, the executives may choose among themselves who is to serve as the Committee Lead, or the title falls to the highest-ranking executive.

I.4 Spark Party Committee

The Spark Party Committee should consist of at least six unique members, ideally comprised of two IEEE Executive Board members, two representatives from the Women in Electrical and Computer Engineering (WECE) club, and two from IEEE Eta Kappa Nu (HKN). Members affiliated with multiple listed organizations must select a single group to represent to prevent overlap and maintain the minimum six-member requirement.

Bylaw J - Branch Lounge

J.1 Lounge Access

Lounge access is restricted to active members who possess an IEEE membership. This is because IEEE funds the room.

J.2 Lounge Policy

Below is the Lounge Policy. This is the governing document for conduct in the lounge. This is to be posted in the lounge for reference and to be adhered to. Failure to abide by the Lounge Policy will result in losing lounge access.

By gaining access to the Branch's Lounge in AK 106, you agree to abide by the following rules. Having our own space on campus is a privilege, and these rules help keep the space functional and clean for everyone! The executive board reserves the right to revoke lounge access if these policies are not respected.

1. Regular access to the lounge is reserved exclusively for lounge members. The requirements for lounge members are defined in the bylaws.
2. Guests are permitted for short periods of time under supervision by a lounge member.

3. Usage of lounge space, tools, and resources is first come first serve.
4. Do not host meetings in the lounge unless they are IEEE-related.
5. Do not take other people's belongings. This includes, but is not limited to, food, electronics, and personal items.
6. Do not remove shared items from the lounge. This includes, but is not limited to, supplies, furniture, and equipment.
7. Clean up after you leave. This includes, but is not limited to, ensuring surfaces and project areas are kept tidy.
8. Please try to label food in the fridge with your name. Food over a week old will be thrown out without notice.
9. Be nice to others! We're all friends here!

We're trying to build an open, fun, collaborative place on campus. This space belongs to all of us — we want you to bring your personal touch and help make it better! There aren't any rules on what items should/shouldn't be in the lounge, so feel free to bring whatever you want. If there's something you think the club should purchase or restock, please let the executive board know!

Glossary

25Live

WPI's campus space reservation platform used by authorized members of the Branch to reserve rooms and other campus spaces for Branch activities.

Active Member

A WPI student who satisfies the active member requirements established in Bylaw C.2, including the required number of membership points within the applicable rolling semester.

Appointment

The selection of an individual by the Executive Board to temporarily fill a vacant executive position outside of the standard election process, as provided in Bylaw H.

Branch

The Institute of Electrical and Electronics Engineers Worcester Polytechnic Institute Student Branch, also referred to as the WPI IEEE Student Branch.

Branch Activity

Any meeting, event, project, committee activity, program, or other activity organized or officially recognized by the Branch.

Branch Bylaws

This document and its provisions governing the organization, membership, Executive Board, meetings, elections, committees, and other operations of the Branch.

Branch Funds

Money available to or administered by the Branch, including its annual budget, funding received through SGA funding requests, external sponsorships, and funds maintained through the Branch's ECE Department gift fund.

Candidate

An eligible nominee who has accepted a nomination for an elected executive position.

Committee Lead

The executive responsible for overseeing a committee, ensuring that committee meeting notes are recorded, and reporting committee activity to the Executive Board.

ECE

The Worcester Polytechnic Institute Department of Electrical and Computer Engineering.

Executive

A WPI undergraduate student who holds a position on the Executive Board.

Executive Board

The central governing authority of the Branch, composed of the Chair, Vice Chair, Treasurer, Secretary, Events Chairs, Projects Chair, Public Relations Chair, and Web Chair.

Executive Board Meeting

A meeting normally held once each week during WPI academic terms at which the Executive Board discusses, plans, and votes on Branch matters. Executive Board Meetings are open to the WPI community.

Executive Term

The period during which an elected executive officially holds their Executive Board position.

Faculty Advisor

A WPI faculty member appointed to advise the Branch in accordance with IEEE requirements and Bylaw A.4.

Flagship Event

A major Branch event intended to occur once per academic term and requiring the formation of a committee to assist with its planning and execution.

Formal Motion

A formal proposal made by an executive during an Executive Board Meeting that is presented for discussion and, when necessary, a vote in accordance with Bylaw F.

Funding Request

A request submitted to the WPI Student Government Association for funding to support a Branch expense or activity.

General Body

The broader membership participating in Branch activities. During elections or other matters involving voting, only individuals who meet the applicable definition of the voting membership may cast a ballot.

GitHub Organization

The Branch's organizational account on GitHub used to host, version-control, and maintain Branch software and technical projects.

Google Drive

The Branch's electronic file storage system maintained as part of the Branch's administrative records.

Highest-Ranking Executive

The eligible executive holding the highest position according to the ranking established in Bylaw D.1. The ranking, from highest to lowest, is Chair, Vice Chair, Treasurer, Secretary, Events Chairs, Projects Chair, Public Relations Chair, and Web Chair.

HKNU

IEEE Eta Kappa Nu, the honor society of the ECE department. Also incorporated with IEEE.

IEEE

The Institute of Electrical and Electronics Engineers.

IEEE Student Membership

Student-level membership in IEEE. Executives are required to maintain IEEE Student Membership throughout their term in office.

Impeachment

The process of removing an executive from office through a formal motion and vote in accordance with the applicable voting requirements of these Bylaws.

Interim Executive

An individual appointed by the Executive Board to temporarily assume the responsibilities and duties of a vacant executive position until the original executive returns from leave or the position is filled through the next general election.

IQP

Interactive Qualifying Project, a WPI degree requirement that may involve a student being away from campus and therefore considered On Leave for purposes of these Bylaws.

Leave / On Leave

A meeting and membership status applying to a person who is away from campus for an academic term for reasons including, but not limited to, an IQP, MQP, or Co-op. A student seeking to exclude such a term from their rolling semester must notify the Executive Board.

Lounge

The Branch space located in AK 106 and governed by Bylaw J and the Lounge Policy.

Lounge Access

Authorization to regularly use the Branch Lounge. Under Bylaw J, regular access is restricted to active members who also possess IEEE membership.

Lounge Member

An active member who possesses IEEE membership and is therefore eligible for regular access to the Branch Lounge.

Majority of a Meeting

More than half of the duration of a meeting. Attendance for the majority of a meeting constitutes the attendance status "In Attendance."

Membership Point

A unit awarded for participation in qualifying Branch activities and used to determine active member status in accordance with Bylaws C.2 and E.2.

Moderator

An executive designated to oversee the procedure of a meeting, election, discussion, or vote. Election moderators are subject to the impartiality requirements established in Bylaw G.3.

Motion

See **Formal Motion**.

MQP

Major Qualifying Project, a WPI degree requirement that may involve a student being away from campus and therefore considered On Leave for purposes of these Bylaws.

myWPI

WPI's student organization platform used by the Branch to manage organizational information, membership, and event information.

Nomination

The process by which an active member proposes an eligible undergraduate active member for election to an executive position.

Nominee

An eligible active member who has been nominated for an executive position. A nominee becomes a candidate upon accepting the nomination.

PCB

Printed Circuit Board.

PCB Design Lecture

A lecture associated with the PCB Design Class for which attendance may earn membership points as specified in Bylaw E.2.

President

An alternative title for the Chair used where required or recognized under WPI Executive Board regulations.

Ranked-Choice Ballot

The election ballot used when more than two candidates seek a single executive position. Each voter may rank up to three candidates in order of preference.

Reimbursement

Repayment from Branch funds for an authorized purchase that was approved before the purchase was made.

Rolling Semester

A contiguous span of two WPI academic terms during which a student is not On Leave. A term of approved leave may be excluded from the rolling period after the student notifies the Executive Board.

SAO

The WPI Student Activities Office.

SGA

The Worcester Polytechnic Institute Student Government Association.

Vacancy / Vacant Executive Position

An Executive Board position that is not currently occupied by its elected executive. A vacancy may result from resignation, impeachment, failure to elect an executive, early graduation, leave, or another circumstance described in Bylaw H.

Vice President

An alternative title for the Vice Chair used where required or recognized under WPI Executive Board regulations.

vTools

IEEE's online organizational reporting system used by the Branch for tasks including Branch planning, activity reporting, and executive reporting.

WCS

The IEEE Worcester County Section.

WECE

Women in Electrical and Computer Engineering, a WPI student organization referenced in connection with the Spark Party Committee.

WPI

Worcester Polytechnic Institute.